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# If I Update My WordPress Theme/Plugin, Will I Lose All My Customizations?

Yusuf Mudagal 24 Dec 2022 2 min read

Updating your WordPress theme or plugin can be a daunting task, especially if you're worried about losing all of your customizations. As a WordPress development (https://codetrappers.com/development-for-wordpress/) agency, CodeTrappers often gets asked this question by our clients.

First, it's important to understand that updating your theme or plugin is generally a good thing to do. WordPress releases updates regularly to fix security vulnerabilities and improve performance. However, it's natural to be concerned about losing the customizations you've made to your site.

The good news is that, in most cases, your customizations will not be lost when you update your theme or plugin. WordPress stores your customizations in the database, which is separate from the theme or plugin files. This means that when you update the theme or plugin, your customizations will still be there.

However, it's always a good idea to back up your website before updating any theme or plugin, just in case something goes wrong. This will allow you to restore your website to a previous version if necessary.

There are a few exceptions to this rule. If you have made customizations directly to the theme or plugin files, those changes will be lost when you update. It's generally a good practice to avoid making customizations directly to the theme or plugin files, as they can be overwritten during an update. Instead, try using a child theme or a plugin to make your customizations. This way, they will be preserved when you update the parent theme or plugin.

In summary, updating your WordPress theme or plugin will not generally cause you to lose your customizations. However, it's always a good idea to back up your website before making any updates, and to avoid making customizations directly to the theme or plugin files. CodeTrappers can help you update your theme or plugin safely and smoothly, so don't hesitate to reach out to us for assistance.

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